DieCard Collector, The trading card collectors' solution for easy organization

Team Cramorant

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Problem Statement:

Trading card collectors lack efficient ways to organize data about their cards. For example, many current trading card apps, such as Archidekt, require users to manually select each unique print of their card and search for the card name. DexTCG is a mobile-required app that is inaccessible to those without an iOS device or a phone. If the user does not have an iOS device or wishes to access data on a computer, prior preferred solutions may not be applicable. How can we design an accessible web application that prioritizes input efficiency and user experience?

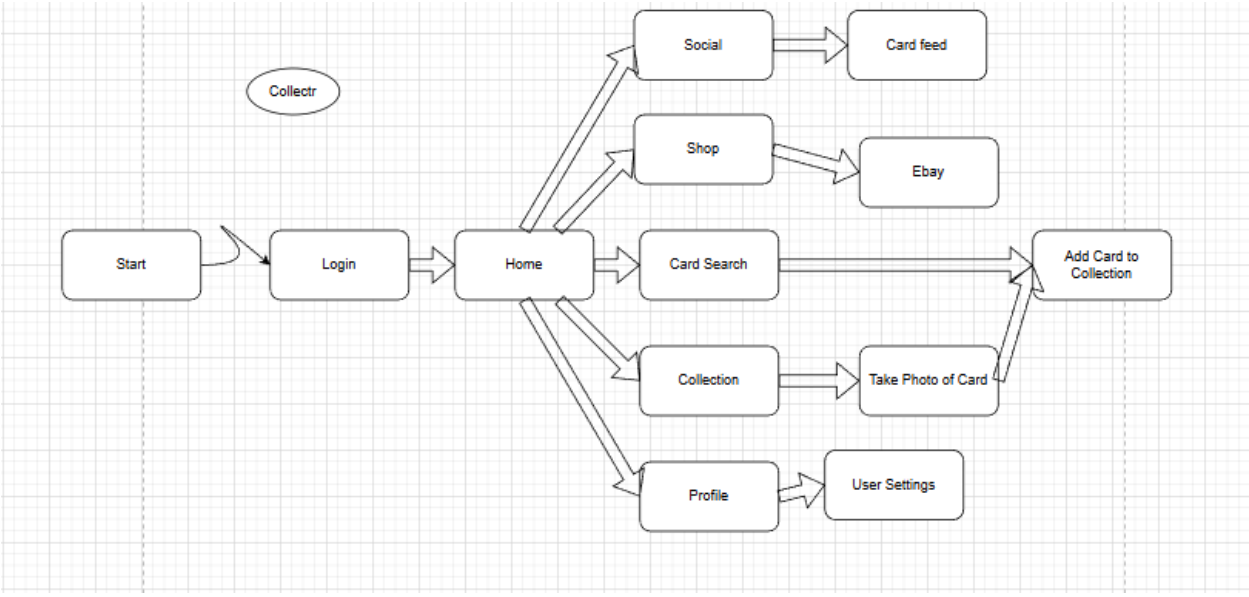
Prior Solutions

Solution 1: Collectr

Collectr is a free app where its users catalog their collection while displaying card prices. A card is input using the camera on the user's phone. The app then identifies the card, its condition, and the current market price. The homepage of the app displays the entire value of the collection and the biggest changes in card value that have happened in the selected time frame. The user can upload 35 cards for free before paying for a premium account. There are different tabs to access the

user's collection, the card market, the user profile, and a social tab for promoting cards.

Our app will differ from Collectr by implementing only the collection feature and requiring users to input their cards manually. However, our collection feature will have many unique ways to organize and sort cards, such as allowing our users to group the cards themselves and create new categories. Our app will also be free to use.

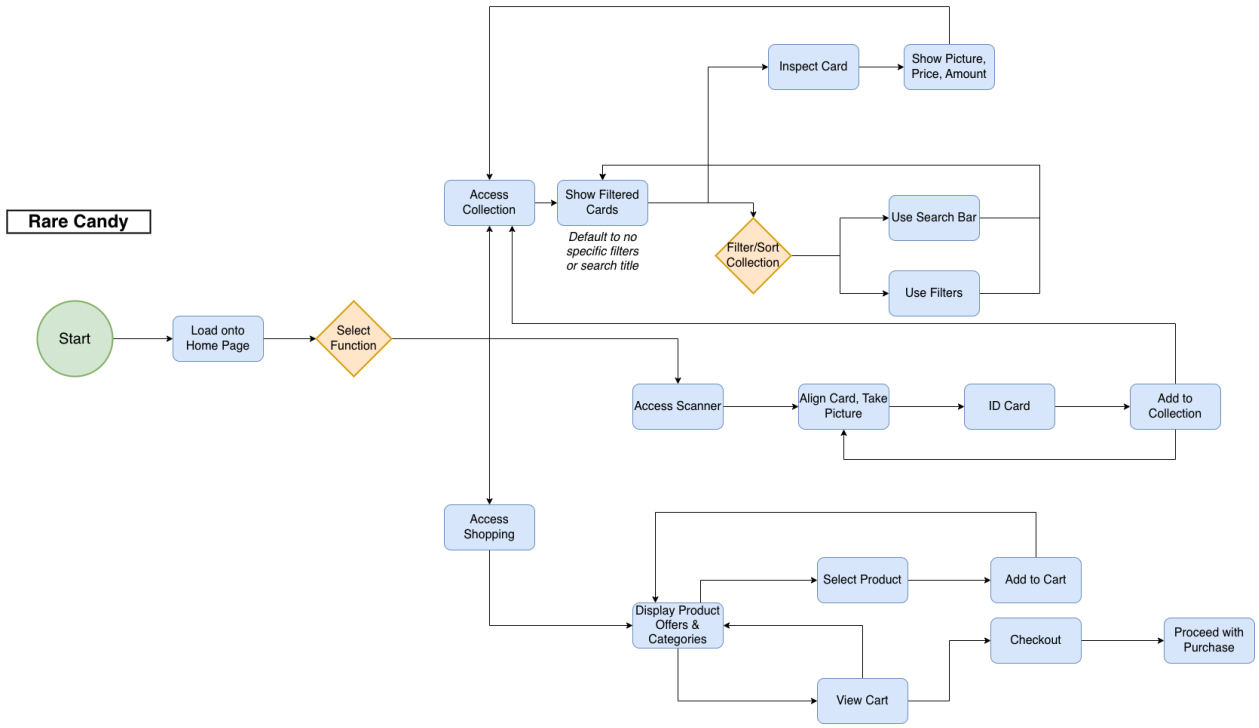


Solution 2: Rare Candy

Rare Candy is an app available on Android and iOS devices. The app allows you to organize a digital collection of physical cards. This is done with a scanner that uses the phone camera. When a card is within the bounds, image recognition software runs and finds the exact card from a card database. In the Collection tab, high-resolution images, card name, price, and amount owned are displayed for each input card. In the last 24 months, the app has expanded its functionality to include a shopping feature. Individual raw cards, sealed products, and professionally graded cards can be listed in an eBay-style market.

Our app will be different by centering entirely on the collection aspect. The app will include many easily discoverable and accessible features to organize collections

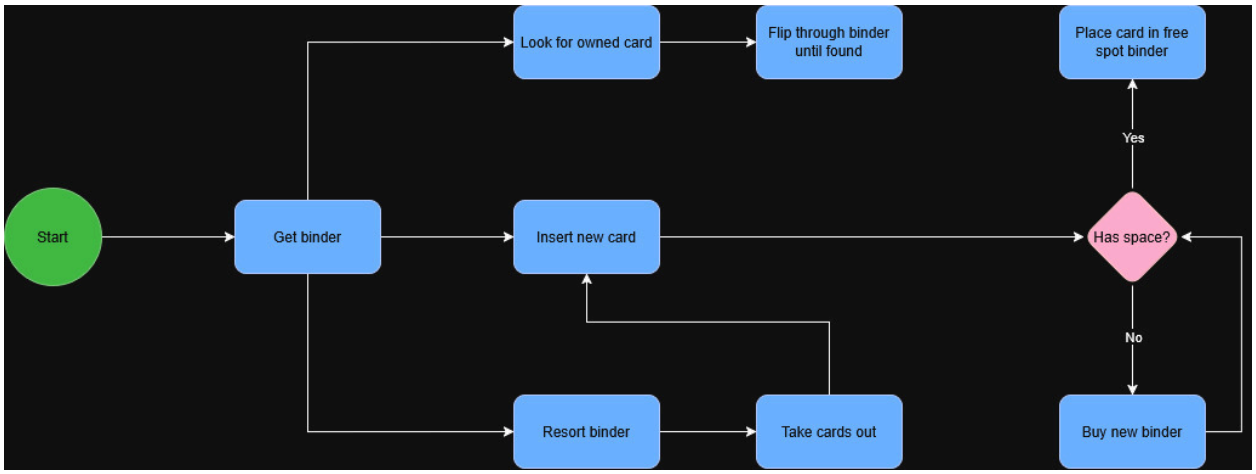
and cards in unique, customizable ways. While the functionality of a scanner is out of the scope of this project, multiple methods of adding cards to the user's collection will be implemented (such as adding by name or adding by searching card features).



Solution 3: Organized Physical Binders

Before many of these apps—and still currently—many collectors simply use binders to organize their cards. By placing cards in the same collection within the same binder, collectors can easily find the cards they are looking for while leaving space for missing/desired cards. This is effective because it gives the user executive control over their organization, is guaranteed to be bug-free, and has no computer dependency. It is, however, ineffective for organizing large numbers of cards, as binders have limited space. Buying more binders carries an additional cost, and common binders cannot hold graded cards in hard plastic containers. Additionally, refactoring any finished sorts is a complete pain; previous collections must be uprooted or heavily reorganized to make new ones with the new cards.

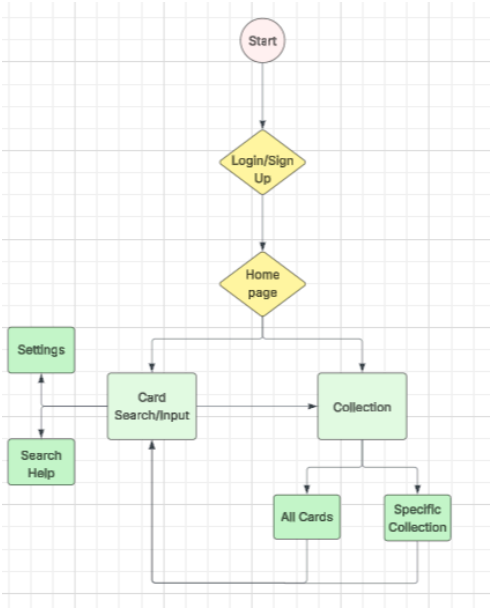
Our app will differ in that keeping track of a large number of cards will be easy. While our collections will be similar to physical binders, users will be able to easily sort, re-sort, and keep track of their cards without worrying about damaging cards, buying binders and sleeves, or tedious handwork.



https://drive.google.com/file/d/1aDL-hNPG80oXz_fiOAgEB38lnUr7BUIW/view?usp=sharing

DieCard Collector

DieCard Collector will allow users to log in or sign up when the website is opened. It will then prompt the user to either search for cards or to go to their collection. It should be effortless for the user to switch between these pages. The goal for the website is to support adding any card from major trading card games, such as Pokémon or Magic: The Gathering.



[Task Flow Diagram]

Another goal is to let the user navigate to their desired choice as fast as possible. Since the three core ideas are closely related, it will be easy for a user to navigate to any page from anywhere on the site.

The search system allows the user to find any card based on its qualities. Common examples are type/color, ability, and name. This lets the user find the card they are searching for efficiently. If they desire, they can add it to their collection. The search system will prioritize the most recent version of a card, and options will allow the user to change it if they are searching for an older printing.

The card collection portion will allow users to create a main card collection. Specialized lists based on their real-life counterparts can also be created. Users will be able to add cards they are looking for to these other lists, even if they do not physically own the card at that time. These lists show the user what cards remain unowned. This area will also allow users to filter based on the card game they are currently looking for.

DieCard Collector will offer a more intuitive search system that benefits knowledgeable players, highlighting the cards' prowess in gameplay. It will also let users input cards they want in addition to the ones they own. The website also supports multiple trading card games to sort, rather than just one.

Brief Feature List

Registration with Login
Have the option for different collection groups
Search system for different criteria (type, name, ability?)
Search page for your entire collection
Search by specific collection
Option to show cards that you want but don't have.
A page that describes the search system (help page/popup)
Different groups for different tcg formats